

The public interest in the market of 1872 was checked partly by dear money and partly by apprehensions that the policy of contracting the greenbacks would make a great scarcity of funds throughout the country. This apprehension was well founded, as the panic of 1873 was essentially a money panic. The bull market of 1879 was checked largely by the creation of new railway securities growing out of the expansion in that period of western and southwestern roads. Money was a factor in the case, but it was not the main one. The bull period in 1890 was checked by the selling of American securities from London and was due especially to the Baring panic.

It seems reasonably certain that the present bull market will be checked, when the time comes, by the creation of a greater supply of industrial stocks than the public will be able to absorb. Vast as the surplus fund is, it is no match for the printing presses of the country. We think, however, that while the character of the end of the bull market is tolerably clear, the time is, at least, a year away. It may be considerably more than that.

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*When the public mind has a well-defined tendency, either bullish or bearish, it is not easily changed. Scores or hundreds of people may change, but the mass press on in the same direction.*

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The evidence on this point is that to which we have frequently referred. The creation of new securities has not been very large until this year. There has not been time to get them distributed. The public hardly knows the names of many of the new industrials. Before the public will absorb these stocks, there must be a period during which they are made popular and profitable. The public must see them quoted and must learn more or less about them before it will